

2.0 SELECTION AND PREPARATION OF CAR

2.1 Be careful around railroad equipment. If you are unfamiliar with the proper way to operate equipment, check with your supervisor and obtain the proper training needed to safely do your job.

2.2 Cars must be inspected by shipper at loading point to verify that cars are in suitable condition. Car interiors must have, but are not limited to, sound roofs, sides, floors, and endwalls; and operable, snug-fitting doors. Any exception is cause for the car to be rejected. See [paragraph 3.6, “Opening and Closing of Doors,”](#) for further information on railcar doors. See UFC 6000-M, Rule 27, for further information.

2.3 Before attempting to open the doors of any railcar, check to make sure that all hardware is intact so that the doors open safely. Check the door tracks to make sure they are equipped with stops on the ends so that the doors do not fall off when opened.

- Check locking bars and related hardware to make sure you can safely open plug doors.
- Make sure the doors are operating correctly before fully opening them. There is always the possibility that material or lading may be leaning against the inside doors or is applying pressure.
- Use care when opening any type of railcar door to protect against injury.

2.4 Always check the car to see if water entry is possible. Make sure that the car is watertight. Look for light leaks or evidence of new or large amounts of rust, which may indicate recent water entry into the car.

(Note to shippers: Notify appropriate carriers immediately if railcars are received with water damage to ensure that the car is shopped and repaired before the car is used again.)

2.5 Check the car floors for any holes or rough surfaces that may result in leakage or damage to the product.

2.6 It is important that boxcars are clean and free from protruding nails, brads, staples, temporary anchor plates, fragments of steel strap, old blocking, etc. Some projections of lining or anchor devices may require covering with sheets of corrugated fiberboard taped in place.

2.7 Check the endwalls to make sure they are not bowed. If the endwall is severely bowed, reject the car. If the endwalls are bowed and you need to use the car, use materials of appropriate size and strength (such as filler panels) to bring the endwalls back to square. This will help to ensure that the load remains tight during its journey.

2.8 If the car supplied is not suitable for loading and the shipper elects to load the car rather than reject it, it is the shipper’s responsibility to properly prepare the car.

2.9 Cover rough surfaces with fiberboard sheets or other suitable materials. Do not use kraft paper.

2.10 In refrigerator cars, cover floor racks with at least a single thickness of corrugated fiberboard, placing the corrugations lengthwise of the car to prevent rolling or bunching. Abut sheets on the floor and do not overlap. Make the interior endwall adjacent to the motor compartment flush with the endwalls by adding several thicknesses of corrugated fiberboard.

2.11 When plug doors do not provide a flush surface with the car’s sidewalls, use protective material such as corrugated fiberboard.

2.12 The loading methods illustrated in this guide have a proven track record of success in specific car types. Please note the type of car for which each method is used. Failure to use the proper loading method in the proper type of equipment will result in damage to the product and a dissatisfied customer (i.e., if a loading method is shown for use in a cushion equipped car, use that loading method only in cushion-equipped cars).